



TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 10

Date: Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: Powder-Actuated Tool Safety

OVERVIEW:

Powder-actuated tools use a controlled explosive charge to drive fasteners into concrete and structural steel. They are faster and more powerful than pneumatic tools and require a completely different level of training and respect. Only workers who have passed a PAT certification course are legally permitted

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. A powder-actuated tool fires a fastener using a cartridge that is similar to a blank firearm cartridge. The energy released is substantial — enough to drive a hardened steel fastener through concrete and structural steel. If used incorrectly, that same energy can drive a fastener completely through a hollow-core wall, a wood stud, or a thin substrate, sending it out the other
2. Never fire closer than 3 inches from any edge of the base material. Material edges are weak points, and driving a fastener near an edge can fracture the base material and send fragments and the fastener in unpredictable directions. Also maintain at least 3-inch spacing between fasteners for the same reason. Edges and closely spaced fasteners lead to spalling.
3. Misfires must be handled with extreme care. If a cartridge does not fire, keep the tool pointed in a safe direction and wait at least 30 seconds before attempting to open the breech. The cartridge may be a hangfire — a delayed ignition — and can fire after what appears to be a misfire. After waiting, extract the cartridge per the manufacturer's procedure and place it in water, not in a
4. Store PAT cartridges separately from the tool and in their original containers. Cartridges are explosive materials and must be treated accordingly. Never carry loose cartridges in your pocket. Never leave the tool loaded and unattended. At the end of the day, account for all cartridges used and return unused ones to secure storage.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

Q1: Who on this crew is currently certified to operate powder-actuated tools?

Q2: What do you do if a PAT does not fire? Walk through the procedure.

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- Only operators with current PAT certification may use these tools
- Test for hollow materials first — tool can penetrate completely
- Never fire closer than 3 inches from any edge
- Store cartridges separately from tools in approved containers
- Wear hearing protection and eye protection at all times

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.



CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 10

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)	#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)
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